



Efficient asteroid mining

If we want to make asteroid mining a reality soon, we need to have better approaches to it.
<http://dgit.in/AstrdMining>



Highly accurate GPS

Rather than the five metre range, upcoming smartphone devices will be accurate up to 30 centimetres.
<http://dgit.in/AccrtGPS>

What an idea!

Students across India are innovating their way to the future. Here's a look at some of the best student innovation platforms in the country.

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fter a particularly harrowing day at school, with creative arts and sports classes on the same

day, Harish couldn't wait to get back home. While many other students his age would look forward to rushing into the kitchen or dropping down on the bed the moment they reach home, Harish drops his bag and runs to the one thing on his mind these days – his water-purification project that would some day offer clean water to everyone in India for free. But even if he could finish it, how would he make it reach far and wide across the country? The answer lies with student innovation competitions and awards.

For Harish and thousands of kids like him, student innovation competitions and awards have given their ideas the necessary support for taking them closer to reality. Here are some of the most notable student innovation platforms that Indian students can participate in and the ideas that have come out of them.

IMAGINE CUP

As an annual competition organised by Microsoft, Imagine Cup has always had the overarching theme of solving the world's problems with technology. Started off in 2003, today it hosts more than 358,000 competitors representing 183 countries and regions. As for the eligibility, you must be either a high-school student, an undergraduate or a graduate to participate. Head over to <https://imagine.microsoft.com>

to register yourself with a Microsoft Account. While the next year's competition is yet to be announced, a look at some of the winners of the past editions can help you get charged up for it – be it the battery-less glucose metre from this year's global winner X.GLU or India's very own Content Holmes that reached the global quarterfinals in the same year.

JAMES DYSON AWARD

Running for the past 13 years in 23 countries, James Dyson Awards, an initiative by British household appliance manufacturer Dyson, held its first Indian edition earlier this year. The competition invites ideas in the realm of engineering design from students

across the world. To be eligible for the contest, you need to be a university level student (or recent graduate) in the fields of product design, industrial design and engineering. Check out <https://jamesdysonaward.org/> for more details on the competition.

Past winners have come up with some really innovative ideas like the Lixten open ear, unobtrusive wireless headphone for people with glasses, or Mattam, a retrofit patient transfer system that can effectively transfer patients without causing any pain - designed by Asish Mohandas from IIT Kanpur, the winner of the first Indian leg of the competition.

INDIA INNOVATION CHALLENGE DESIGN CONTEST (IICDC)

This particular contest was launched by Texas Instruments (TI) and is supported by the Department of Science and Technology (DST), as well as IIM Bangalore. Even though it focuses on the entrepreneurial aspect of innovation, one look at the winners list of the 2016 edition will show you that this one is equally serious about actual technological innovations as well (<http://dgit.in/IICDC2016>). While the initial rounds deal with proposals, teams reaching the Quarterfinals are provided tools worth \$200 by TI to convert their idea into a



Sir James Dyson himself judges the finalists